



## Policy

# Patient Transfer from SCGH to an Authorised Mental Health Facility

## Scope

| Site | Service/Department/Unit | Disciplines |
|------|-------------------------|-------------|
| SCGH | Hospital-Wide           | All Staff,  |

## Introduction

Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital (SCGH) is committed to ensuring the safety of patients, staff and the general public. It is the responsibility of SCGH to ensure safe practice in the transfer of patients to mental health facilities.

## Risk Statement

Non-compliance with this policy will:

|                                       |                                     |                                   |                                     |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Breach legislative requirements       | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Impact on Patient Quality of Care | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Breach National/State/Hospital Policy | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Impact on Patient Safety          | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Breach professional standards         | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | Misconduct                        | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| Breach SCGOPHCG Mission & Values      | <input type="checkbox"/>            | Staff Safety                      | <input type="checkbox"/>            |
| Other:                                | <input type="checkbox"/>            |                                   |                                     |

## Policy Principles

### Patients under the Mental Health Act 2014

If a patient is under the [Mental Health Act 2014](#) (MHA 2014), the relevant forms will be completed and placed in the patient's medical record.

Most observed forms in the emergency department and general hospital setting are:

- [Form 1A](#) Referral for examination by a psychiatrist
- [Form 3A](#) Detention order
- [Form 4A](#) Transport order
- [Form 6A](#) Inpatient treatment order
- [Form 6B](#) Inpatient treatment order in a general hospital

Once a bed has been confirmed at the receiving authorised mental health facility a Transport Order (form 4A) is to be completed by medical staff or Authorised Mental Health Practitioners if deemed appropriate.

All forms last for a predetermined period and the expiry date should be noted.

Blank copies of forms are available via the [Chief Psychiatrist website](#).

### Notification of Transfer

Transfer to an authorised mental health facility with a Form 4A Transport Order/4C Transfer Order is a notifiable event of the MHA 2014.

Where possible the next of kin or 'personal support person' is to be advised of the transfer and location of the accepting mental health facility / hospital.

### Transport

All patients under the MHA 2014 are to be transported by Wilson Medic One 1300284940 Operational Hours 24 hours 7 days per week.

If a patient has a Form 4A Transport Order, then a [Mental Health Transport Risk Assessment](#) must be completed.

Wilson Medic One transport officers are to be provided with a copy of all MHA forms.

### Nurse Escort

A nurse escort is not required when patients are transferred by Wilsons Medic One.

### Police Escorts

A police escort may be required if:

- the individual is deemed a significant risk to self/others (as outlined on the transport risk assessment)
- there is evidence that neither use of physical restraint/medication has reduced the risk staff.

The process for seeking WA Police assistance with Transport Orders involves the following:

- Log transfer request and obtain a CAD (Computer Aided Dispatch) job number – PH: 131 444
- E-mail Transport Order and Mental Health Transport Risk Assessment - [Communications.Mental.Health.Smail@police.wa.gov.au](mailto:Communications.Mental.Health.Smail@police.wa.gov.au). Please include in email subject heading: 'MH Transport Forms CAD No. (Actual no)'
- Follow up contact number for inquiries regarding the request – PH: 9323 5567 (**NB not for logging the job or obtaining CAD number**).
- If there are IT/email related issues and forms cannot be sent via email, the fax number is 9370 5510.
- Request details:
  - Police officers leave side-arms behind
  - Estimated time of arrival at the hospital

When the police arrive provide them with copies of the Form 4A and the Mental Health Transport Risk Assessment and give a brief handover of management plan.

### Voluntary patients

If the patient being transferred is not under the MHA, the transfer can be carried out by whichever means are safe and timely; this should be advised by the assessing clinician(s).

Examples of transport options include:

- Individual organises their own transport via family or own vehicle
- Hospital transport
- Wilsons Medic One (Wilson Medic One transport voluntary patients between the hours of 0600 – 0100 only).

Some individuals may require a nurse escort and the Shift Co-ordinator can organise this.

Voluntary patients being transferred to the SCGH Mental Health Unit or Mental Health Observation Area can be walked down with a nurse escort providing the assessing clinician has assessed the risks

Do not send the SCGH hospital file to the SCGH MHU. Photocopies are appropriate.

### **Transfer of patients**

Contact the accepting mental health facility ward and advise that the patient is leaving SCGH and give an estimated time of arrival (ETA)

Documentation of inter-facility clinical handover must be included in the medical record and will include:

- Pertinent clinical information (using the iSoBAR structure) time and date of clinical handover,
- Contact details of at least one of each of the providing and receiving clinicians,
- Past and current treatment, including procedures, therapies and dates performed,
- Significant diagnostic test results and test results pending,
- Care plans / management plans including risk assessments.

All transfer of care should be formally handed over at time of, or prior to, transfer. In addition to a verbal component, inter-facility transfers must involve a detailed transfer document or discharge summary. This document should be sent with the patient if transferring with a nurse escort, Hospital Transport or Wilson Medic One.

### **Compliance, monitoring and evaluation**

Compliance will be monitored as part of the:

1. Clinical Incident Management (CIM) system process including any transfer or escort breaches
2. Compliments/Complaints Management System
3. % of MH patients transferred to another authorised MH facility from SCGH

### **Related Documents**

- [Mental Health Act 2014](#)
- [WA Health – Mental health patient transport page](#)
- [Mental Health Risk Assessment Form](#)

## Authorisation & Version Control

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                |            |              |            |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------|--------------|------------|
| Policy Sponsor                | SCGOPHCG Area Director Nursing Services                                                                                                                                                                           |                |            |              |            |
| Policy Contact                | SCGOPHCG Nurse Director Patient Flow Unit                                                                                                                                                                         |                |            |              |            |
| Date First Issued:            | 01/07/1998                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Last Reviewed: | 08/03/2023 | Review Date: | 08/03/2026 |
| Version No.                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Reference #:   | HP205      |              |            |
| Approved by:                  | SCGOPHCG Area Director Nursing Services                                                                                                                                                                           |                |            | Date:        | 08/03/2026 |
| Endorsed by:                  | SCGOPHCG Policy and Guideline Committee                                                                                                                                                                           |                |            | Date:        |            |
| Standards Applicable          | Insert relevant NSQHS Standards (Version 2):   |                |            |              |            |
| Aboriginal Health ISD Number: | 2102                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                |            |              |            |

For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request for a person with a disability.

## Appendix 1: Police and Wilsons Medic One

Patient requires transport to an authorised mental health facility and requires police and Wilson Medic One



Log request and obtain Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) number by phoning 131444



Email Transport Order (Form A4) and Risk Assessment Matrix

**Email Address: [Communications.Mental.Health.Smail@police.wa.gov.au](mailto:Communications.Mental.Health.Smail@police.wa.gov.au)**  
**Subject Heading: MH Transport Forms CAD No. (insert CAD number obtained)**

Include the following:

- a request to leave side-arms behind
- request estimated time of arrival
- the location they are to attend (Emergency Department or Lower Ground Floor Gold Lifts for patients)
- a contact number for them withing the hospital

**In the event of an IT issue, fax all documentation to 9370 5510**



For any follow up information please call 9323 5567 and have CAD ready



Upon police arriving provide copies of Form A4 and Risk Assessment Matrix and a brief handover or management plan.

Contact Wilson Medic One on 1300 284 940 and advise that police are on site for transfer